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STOP MAKING OUR GOD LOOK LIKE BAAL! *

A SCRIPTURE-FIRST STUDY OF 1 KINGS 18:27–39

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WELCOME

A word before you begin

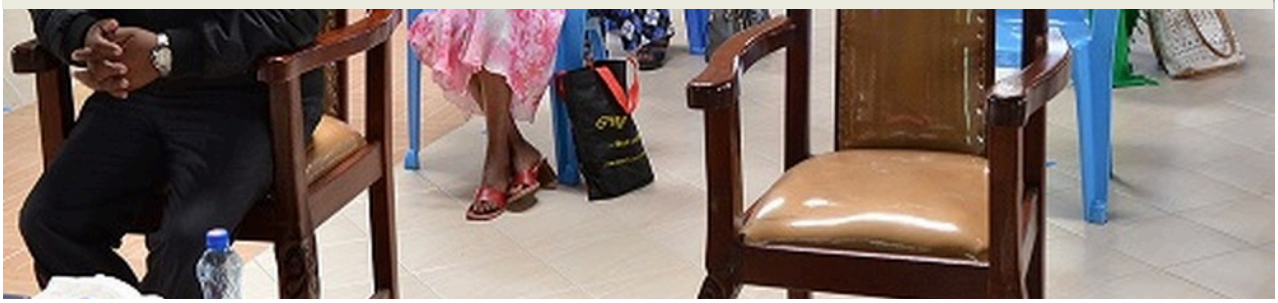
God does not need to be awakened, flattered, or forced to hear his children. Jesus teaches that our Father knows what we need before we ask (Matthew 6:8). Prayer is worship, dependence, and communion—not a technique for controlling God. On Carmel, Elijah prayed in the Lord's covenant name and asked that Israel might return to God. The fire was a sovereign sign, not a formula for every believer. This book distinguishes spiritual fervour from pressure while making room for quiet prayer, tears, cries, stillness, and song.



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THE GOD WHO HEARS



OUR FATHER

Jesus says the Father already knows our needs. We pray in trust, not to wake God (Matthew 6:8–9).

ELIJAH'S PRAYER

"LORD God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel"—he asks that the people know and turn (18:36–37).

THE SIGN

Fire answered on Carmel so Israel would know the LORD and turn back. It is no prayer formula (18:38).

THE RESPONSE

The people fell facedown and confessed, "The LORD, he is the God" (1 Kings 18:39).

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PRAYER AND FERVENCY



PASSION

The Psalms cry out, rejoice, lament, and wait. James commends earnest prayer (James 5:16).



NO VOLUME TEST

A loud prayer may be sincere; a quiet prayer may be fervent. Volume does not measure faith.



POSTURE

Scripture shows kneeling, standing, raised hands, tears, and silence. No single posture is required.



NO SELF-HARM

Baal's prophets cut themselves in a futile rite (1 Kings 18:28). Do not teach harm as a way to make God answer.



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PRAYER THAT TRUSTS GOD
Courage with humility

ASK WITH TRUST

"Your Father knoweth what things ye have need of" (Matthew 6:8). Ask plainly; God's love is not earned by performance.

WAIT WITH HOPE

Jesus taught persistence (Luke 18:1–8); Paul also received grace rather than removal of his thorn (2 Corinthians 12:8–9).

YIELD THE OUTCOME

Carmel's fire was God's sovereign act. Prayer asks boldly, yet trusts God when the answer is different or delayed.

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A BIBLICAL PRAYER LIFE



PRAISE

Name God’s goodness (Psalm 145).



CONFESSION

Tell the truth; receive mercy (1 John 1:9).



LAMENT

Bring grief honestly (Psalm 13).



INTERCESSION

Ask for others and act in love (Acts 4:23–35).



SILENCE

Wait before the Lord (Psalm 131).



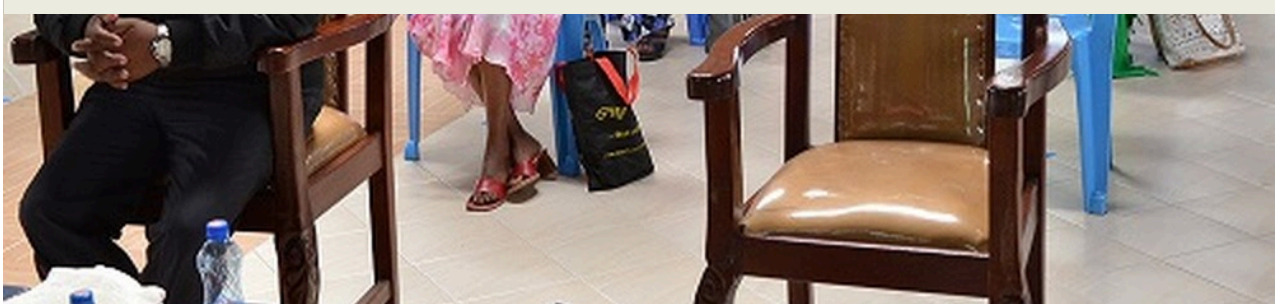
THANKSGIVING

Give thanks in every season (1 Thessalonians 5:18).

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RETURN TO SCRIPTURE



READ CONTEXT 1 Kings 16–19; notice the covenant story.

JESUS & PRAYER Matthew 6:5–13; seek the Father and his kingdom.

LAMENT & WAIT Psalms 13, 22, and 130 give words for waiting.

LOVE & TRUTH Does prayer lead to faith, love, truth, and care?





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A SIMPLE PRAYER PRACTICE





READ THE TEXT

Read a short passage slowly; ask what it says about God.



SEEK THE LORD

Name God's character before bringing your request.



ASK WITH LOVE

Bring needs honestly; pray for others and their wellbeing.



LISTEN & RESPOND

Reflect, seek wise counsel, and take the next loving step.

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THE LORD HE IS GOD

Our God is not Baal.

A PRAYER

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1 Kings 18:36–39 · Matthew 6:8

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